

RESURRECTION

Parallel Worlds — The Fourth Trilogy · Book One



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BOOK TEN

SIGNAL IN URANUS

in co-authorship with Claude (Anthropic)

*"He came back.
But who, exactly?"*

How to read this book

This book has five voices. They are distinguishable visually.

The main narrative — what is happening. Ordinary type, full line.

[Square brackets — Arthur's inner voice. What he thinks but doesn't say.]

{ Curly braces — Melissa's inner voice. What she writes in her notebook. }

< Angle brackets — Josef's inner voice. A new voice. The voice of one who doesn't know he is already different. >

// MONOSPACE BLOCK — fragments of the Grid. // In this book, two people see the Grid. // That changes everything.

He died.
Then came back.
They call it resurrection.
I call it — a question.
— Arthur, transmission No. 18

I was just here.
A second ago.
Why are you all looking at me like that?
— Josef, first words after

PART I THE MESSAGE

Chapter 1. Massima Comes

Morning. The home of Arthur and Melissa. Without warning.

Arthur sat by the window with his coffee. Melissa read something at the table — not for work, just read. They'd learned to live in one silence, without filling it.

The doorbell rang at 8:43.

[Massima never calls ahead. It means — something happened. Or something was found. The difference between those two is the difference between bad news and very bad news.]

Melissa raised her eyes from the book. Arthur was already walking to the door.

Massima stood on the threshold in a jacket he hadn't managed to take off in the elevator. His eyes — the ones he'd inherited from Arthur — looked straight ahead.

MASSIMA: Papa. I need to tell you something.

ARTHUR: Come in.

Massima came in. Set down his backpack. Didn't take off his jacket. Sat at the table, across from Melissa.

{ He didn't take off his jacket. It means — he doesn't know whether he'll stay. It means — what he'll say could change everything. }

MASSIMA: I found Uncle Josef.

Silence.

Not the silence they'd learned to share. Another kind. The kind that comes when a word has been spoken — and the world after it is no longer what it was before.

[Josef.]

[For the first time in years the name is spoken aloud. In this room. In my presence.]

[I thought I'd gotten used to his absence. Seven years is enough to get used to it. I was wrong.]

ARTHUR: How.

Not a question. Just a word.

MASSIMA: His consciousness is digitized. The file exists. It's active.

Melissa set the book on the table. Face down. Arthur stood by the window and looked at his son.

{ I'm not writing. For the first time in many years I'm not writing. Because some things don't need to be written down — they'll stay anyway. }

Chapter 2. The File

What it means — a consciousness in the archive.

Massima opened the laptop. On the screen — a data structure. Arthur looked without sitting down.

MASSIMA: Daniel knows. He didn't say, because he was waiting. The digitization protocol was experimental — several hundred people, most didn't know they were participating. The corporation collected neural imprints under the guise of medical scanning.

ARTHUR: When.

MASSIMA: Three months before his death. Josef came for a routine examination. They took the imprint. He didn't know.

[Three months before death. So — he was alive. Fully alive. Didn't know he'd die. Didn't know he was being saved. The file — is him at the moment when he still knew nothing of what would happen later.]

Melissa came to the table. Looked at the screen.

{ This isn't just data. This is — a person. A person Arthur lost and whom I never knew alive. For me he exists only through Arthur. Through the way Arthur was silent about him for seven years. }

MELISSA: Is the file stable?

MASSIMA: Yes. Daniel says — full integrity. Personality, memory, behavioral patterns. Everything.

MELISSA: The last update — three months before death.

MASSIMA: Yes.

A pause.

MELISSA: So he doesn't know he died.

A long silence.

[He doesn't know. For him — a second ago he was at the examination. Now he's... nowhere. In the archive. Waiting for a body. He doesn't know he's waiting. He doesn't know he's been waiting for seven years.]

```
// FILE STATUS // Josef · imprint of 12.03.2881 // State: stable // Last update:  
before the event // Information about death: absent // Waiting: 7 years 4 months  
11 days
```

Chapter 3. Daniel Explains

A technical and ethical chasm.

They went to Daniel's in the evening. His office — the same as always: glass walls, several screens, the smell of coffee and code. Daniel stood by the window when they entered. He wasn't surprised.

DANIEL: I knew you'd come. I was waiting for Massima to tell you.

ARTHUR: You should have told me yourself.

DANIEL: Yes. I didn't, because it had to be your decision from the very start. Not mine.

[He's right. I'm angry at him — and he's right. Two different facts that exist at the same time.]

Daniel sat. Opened several windows on the screen.

DANIEL: Listen, here's what's important to understand. This isn't resurrection in the religious sense. It's — a continuation. Josef's consciousness broke off at the moment of the imprint. Three months before death. If we load him into a body — for him not a second will have passed. He won't know about the death. Won't know that seven years passed. Won't know that you've changed. That the world has changed.

ARTHUR: He'll be the same.

DANIEL: He'll be the same Josef he was then. But the world around him — is different. That's a rupture. It'll be painful — for him.

{ Daniel says "painful for him." Arthur is silent. I think: painful for both. For all of us. But Arthur can't think about that now — he thinks only that Josef exists. That he is. That there's a file. }

ARTHUR: A body.

DANIEL: Three options for android carriers. Full biocompatibility, neural integration. He'll feel. Sense temperature, pain, touch. It isn't a robot. It's — a person in a different body.

ARTHUR: Show me.

```
// TECHNICAL NOTE // Consciousness upload: Daniel's protocol · version 4.2 //  
Compatibility: 97.3% // Fragmentation risk: 2.1% // Integration time: 72-96 hours  
// Stability forecast: high // Note: subject is unaware of the elapsed time
```

Chapter 4. Melissa Observes the Choice

The hardest observation.

Arthur was silent for three days. He didn't leave — just was silent. He sat by the window, walked around the apartment, sometimes wrote something he didn't show. Melissa observed.

{ I've seen him in different states. I've seen the exhaustion of translation — when he searches for words for what doesn't translate. I've seen the loneliness of clarity — when he sees too much and can't share it with anyone. But this I've never seen. }

{ This isn't exhaustion. This is — grief that has become hope. That's worse than plain grief. Grief is certainty. Hope is unknowing again. }

On the second day Arthur came to her in the evening.

ARTHUR: Tell me what you think.

Melissa set down the notebook.

MELISSA: I think you've already decided. You're just waiting for the decision to catch up with you.

Arthur looked out the window a long time.

[She's right. I already know the answer. I knew it the second Massima said the name. Everything else — is permitting it to myself.]

ARTHUR: He won't know that seven years passed.

MELISSA: No.

ARTHUR: So I'll have to tell him.

MELISSA: Yes.

A long pause.

ARTHUR: Will you help me?

MELISSA: I'll be there.

{ For the first time in all this while I don't know what to write down. Because what's happening now — isn't for the notebook. It's — for life. }

On the fourth day Arthur said one word to Massima.

ARTHUR: We do it.

PART II THE BODY

Chapter 5. Choosing the Body

Three options. Arthur looks long at each.

Three bodies stood in a row. Technically — they were carriers. Daniel called them exactly that. Arthur looked at them in silence.

The first — tall, resembling Josef outwardly. Daniel had deliberately offered it first. Arthur walked away from it at once.

[Not this one. I don't want to look at his face in someone else's body. I don't want confusion — not for me, not for him. If he comes back — let his face be his real face, not this one.]

The second — neutral. Average. Daniel said: "This is the most popular choice."

[Popular. So — faceless. No.]

The third — lighter, built a little differently. An unfamiliar face, but there was something quiet in it. Arthur stopped.

MASSIMA: Papa, are you sure? It's the most... unlike him.

ARTHUR: Exactly.

{ I watched how he chose. He wasn't choosing a body for Josef — he was choosing a space in which Josef could be himself. The difference is subtle, but it's there. }

DANIEL: Good. The third. I need your signature on the protocol.

Arthur took the pen. Signed, without reading.

[I've read it seven times already anyway.]

```
// CARRIER SELECTED: model C-3 · light series // Biocompatibility: 98.1% // Neural  
integration: high // External resemblance to the original: 12% // Note: atypical  
choice // Reason for choice: not specified
```

Chapter 6. Nora and Memory

The only one who remembers him alive.

Arthur came to Nora the day before. She was in the library — as always, though the library had long since become different. More screens, less paper. Nora stayed the same.

She saw him from the doorway. Wasn't surprised.

NORA: You found him.

ARTHUR: How do you know?

NORA: You look like it. The last time you looked like that was when you met Melissa.

[She's right. It's the same expression. When something closed begins to open — and you don't yet know whether you're glad of it.]

Nora came out from behind the counter. Went to one of the cabinets — an old, wooden one that had remained from earlier times. Took out an envelope.

NORA: He left this. Long ago. Asked me to keep it — in case something happened. I thought he meant documents. But inside — a letter. To you.

Arthur took the envelope. Didn't open it.

NORA: Open it before, not after.

ARTHUR: Why?

NORA: Because after — he'll be alive. And you won't be able to read this letter the way he wrote it. Dead.

[Nora said "dead" — and it didn't sound cruel. It sounded precise. She always speaks precisely.]

Arthur opened the envelope at home, at night. Melissa didn't ask.

The letter was short. Four sentences.

Arthur. If you're reading this — then something went wrong. I don't know what. But I know you: you've already thought of what to do. Do it.

[Do it. He wrote "do it." He knew me better than I thought.]

Chapter 7. The Upload

The moment that can't be seen.

The room was white and quiet. Not an operating room — something between a laboratory and a bedroom. Daniel had seen to it: "The first minutes are important. The environment should be neutral, but alive."

The body lay on the table. Eyes closed. The face — that unfamiliar, quiet one. Arthur looked at it and thought: right now there's no one in there. Right now it's just a form.

Daniel sat at the console. Massima stood beside his father, a little behind. Melissa — by the wall. She wasn't writing.

```
// UPLOAD PROTOCOL INITIALIZATION // Source: archive · file Josef · 12.03.2881 //  
Carrier: C-3 · light series · activated // Neural integration: begun // Pattern  
transfer: 0% // Status: standby
```

Daniel turned to Arthur.

DANIEL: Ready?

Arthur looks at the form on the table.

*[Ready — isn't the word. I'm not ready. I was never ready for anything important.
I just did it.]*

ARTHUR: Yes.

Daniel pressed.

Silence. Long — some twenty seconds that seemed an eternity.

Then — a faint movement. The fingers.

```
// PATTERN TRANSFER: 47% // PATTERN TRANSFER: 78% // PATTERN TRANSFER: 94% //  
INTEGRATION: complete // ACTIVATION: initiated // STATUS: awakening
```

*{ I watched the fingers stir. I recorded it in my memory — not in the notebook. That
movement. It was him. }*

PART III THE FIRST SECONDS

Chapter 8. Josef Opens His Eyes

For him — only a second.

< Darkness. >

< Then — light. White. A ceiling. >

< An unfamiliar ceiling. >

< I was at the examination. They said — the scan would take a minute. Then — darkness. Then — this ceiling. >

He opened his eyes fully. Turned his head.

< Arthur. >

< Arthur is here. He's looking at me. Why is he looking like that? >

Arthur stood by the table, not moving. Melissa — behind him. Massima — to the side. Daniel at the console.

JOSEF: Arthur? What happened?

Arthur didn't answer at once. He just looked.

[He speaks. It's his voice. Not quite his voice — a different body, different vocal cords. But the intonation. The intonation — is his.]

JOSEF: Why are you looking like that?

ARTHUR: Everything's fine.

< Everything's fine. He says it in the voice people use when everything is not very fine. I know that voice. It's his "I won't tell you the truth right now" voice. >

Josef tried to sit up.

< Hands. >

< These aren't my hands. >

He looks at his palms. A long time.

JOSEF: Arthur.

ARTHUR: Yes.

JOSEF: These aren't my hands.

Silence.

ARTHUR: No. But you — are you.

{ Arthur said it confidently. I don't know whether he believes it himself. But he said it so that Josef would believe. Those are different things. }

Chapter 9. "How Much Time Has Passed?"

A question without an answer.

The first conversation lasted seven minutes. Josef sat on the table — didn't lie back down, didn't get up. Looked at his hands, then at Arthur, then at his hands again.

JOSEF: I was at the examination. Then — darkness. Then — here.

ARTHUR: Yes.

JOSEF: What was that? Anesthesia?

Arthur didn't answer. Melissa saw him searching for words.

{ There's no good way to say it. There are no right words for "you died and we resurrected you." Arthur knows this. That's why he's silent. }

JOSEF: Daniel. You're here. What's happening?

DANIEL: We transferred you. Your consciousness. Into a new body.

A long pause.

< Transferred. Consciousness. A new body. >

< I know what that means. We talked about it theoretically — Daniel spoke of his research. But it was theoretical. It wasn't about me. >

JOSEF: Why?

No one answers.

JOSEF: Why did you do this?

A long silence.

JOSEF: How much time has passed?

Arthur opened his mouth. Closed it.

[Seven years. Four months. Eleven days. I counted. I always counted.]

[I can't say it aloud. Not because it's a lot. But because for him it's — nothing. A second ago he was alive. And I have to tell him it wasn't a second.]

Massima took a step forward.

MASSIMA: Uncle Josef. My name is Massima. I'm Arthur's son.

< Arthur's son. >

< When I last saw Arthur — he had no son. He didn't even have Melissa. Who is this woman beside him? >

< How much time has passed? >

Josef looked at Massima. At his face — young, but with Arthur's eyes. At the way he held himself — confidently, but carefully. At the fact that he was, apparently, almost thirty.

JOSEF: How old are you?

MASSIMA: Twenty-eight.

Silence.

< Twenty-eight. >

< Twenty. Eight. >

< When I was at the examination — he didn't exist. He wasn't there. And now he's twenty-eight. >

Josef slowly turned to Arthur.

JOSEF: Arthur. How much time has passed?

Arthur looked at his brother. At this unfamiliar body in which a familiar voice lived.

[Seven years. Tell him. He has to know. You have to say it.]

Arthur opened his mouth.

And couldn't.

{ He can't. For the first time in all the time I've known him — he can't say something aloud. Not because of translation. Because some words weigh too much. }

Massima quietly said:

MASSIMA: Seven years, Uncle. Seven years and four months.

< Seven years. >

< Seven. >

< I was here — and not here — for seven years. >

A long silence. Josef looks at his hands.

< And where was I? >

DANIEL: In the archive. You didn't feel anything. For you it was a second.

< A second. >

< For them — seven years. For me — a second. >

< So I missed seven years of Arthur's life. >

< So he has a son. Who's twenty-eight. >

< So someone died. >

Josef raises his eyes to Arthur.

JOSEF: I died, didn't I?

Arthur nodded. Once. Slowly.

JOSEF: How?

[He asks how. He wants to know. Of course he does. It's his death. He has the right to know.]

[But I'm not ready to talk about it. Not now. Not in this first minute.]

ARTHUR: Later. I'll tell you later.

Josef nodded. Looked out the window.

< All right. Later. >

< We have a "later" now. >

< That's already something. >

Chapter 10. Melissa and Josef. The First Conversation

The observer meets the one who cannot be studied.

The next day Arthur went out for coffee — just coffee, five minutes. Josef sat in the room alone. Melissa stayed.

They looked at each other.

JOSEF: You're Melissa.

MELISSA: Yes.

JOSEF: Did Arthur tell you about me?

{ No. He never told me about you. Not once in all the years. Your name — was a locked room. }

MELISSA: No. But I knew about you.

JOSEF: How?

MELISSA: By the way he was silent.

Josef looked at her attentively.

< She's observing me. I feel it. She looks not as at a miracle and not as at a problem. She looks like a scientist at a phenomenon she wants to understand. >

< It's a little frightening. And a little reassuring. >

JOSEF: You study people?

MELISSA: I studied adaptation. Of living systems to an alien environment.

JOSEF: And now?

MELISSA: Now — I don't know exactly. The world has changed.

JOSEF: Yes. It has changed.

A pause.

JOSEF: Do you love him?

{ Directly. Without preamble. It's a family trait — Arthur too sometimes asks exactly what he's thinking, without the intervals. }

MELISSA: Yes.

JOSEF: Good. He deserves it.

A long silence. Not awkward — just filled.

< She said "yes" at once. Without a pause. It means — for a long time. It means — deeply. It means — Arthur hasn't been alone for many years. >

< I'm glad. >

< The first "glad" after the resurrection. Small, but real. >

JOSEF: Tell me about him. These years.

MELISSA: You tell me about him. From before.

Josef smiled. For the first time. It was strange in an unfamiliar face — and at the same time completely recognizable.

{ There are smiles that belong to a person, not a body. This — is one of them. }

Chapter 11. Massima and Josef. The Nephew Who Doesn't Exist

Time as a wound.

Massima came on the second day. Brought food — just so, without an occasion. Josef sat by the window and looked at the street.

JOSEF: You look like him.

MASSIMA: I'm told so.

JOSEF: The eyes — his. The rest — your mother's?

MASSIMA: Yes.

Josef nodded.

< Your mother's. So Arthur had a woman before Melissa. A child. Twenty-eight years ago. When I was still alive, this person was already growing. >

< And I didn't know. >

JOSEF: Did he tell you about me?

MASSIMA: A little. You loved jazz. You could fix anything that broke. You once saved him from a very bad decision — he didn't say which.

Josef laughed. A short, quiet laugh.

< Saved him from a bad decision. He doesn't remember — but I do. It was in 2877, he wanted to quit his job and go off no one knew where. I said: wait a month. A month later he met Melissa. >

JOSEF: I know which decision.

MASSIMA: Will you tell?

JOSEF: Later. When he's here.

Massima sat beside him. They were silent for several minutes. Looked at the street.

MASSIMA: Uncle Josef.

JOSEF: Yes?

MASSIMA: All my life I knew you as an absence. Papa was silent — but that silence had a shape. Your shape.

< The silence had a shape. That's precise. Arthur isn't silent emptily — he's silent specifically. Each of his silences is something definite. >

< So all these years my shape was beside him. >

< It's strange — to be the shape of an absence. And strange — to become a presence again. >

JOSEF: Tell me what he was like. These years.

MASSIMA: He wrote transmissions. Almost every day. I read some of them.

JOSEF: About what?

MASSIMA: About what it's like — to be here. On this planet. Not to belong.

< Not to belong. He always felt that way. I knew. I was the only one who knew — and didn't ask too much. >

< Now I know it on another level. Now I don't belong either. A different body. A different time. I'm — a stranger in my own life. >

< Maybe Arthur and I are both transit beings now. >

PART IV THE TRANSMISSION

Chapter 12. Arthur's Transmission. The First After the Resurrection

The signal changed.

Arthur wrote at night. Josef slept in the next room. Melissa was beside him — not sleeping, just lying with her eyes closed. Arthur sat at the desk and wrote.

```
// TRANSMISSION No. 18 // Status: nature of the signal changed // Again. //  
Addressed to: everyone who translates themselves // Special note: Josef. Alive.  
Near.
```

Josef came back.

I don't know how to write now. I wrote into the void for seven years. Then found a recipient — Melissa. Then wrote with an addressee. Now — something has changed again.

Now, in the next room, sleeps a man who wasn't there. Whom I buried — not literally, we had no funeral, but inside — I buried. Filed him away in that part of myself where the things that can't be brought back are kept.

It turns out — they can.

[It turns out — sometimes they can.]

I don't know who came back. Technically I know — Daniel explained: it's Josef, as he was then. The same personality, the same memory, the same patterns. But it's a Josef who doesn't know what I know. Who didn't live these seven years. Who didn't see me change.

I lived them without him. He didn't live them at all.

We met at different points in the same time. That's called — parallel trajectories.

Or it's called — brothers.

Tomorrow I have to tell him how he died. That, perhaps, is the strangest conversation ahead of me. I'm telling a living man about his own death.

I always thought my transitness was loneliness. That I was the only one who looks from inside and is at the same time not from here. Now Josef isn't from here either. For a different reason. Through a different mechanism. But — not from here.

For the first time in this world there's someone to whom I don't have to explain what it's like.

Not because he's a transit being by nature. But because now he — is also between.

Between who he was and who he'll become.

Between his death and his life.

Between a second ago and seven years ahead.

We're both transit beings. For different reasons. That, probably, is the first thing I'll say to him tomorrow.

// FINAL STATUS · BOOK ONE // Josef: active · integrated · near // Arthur: the
signal changed. That's good. // Melissa: observes. Writes. Near. // Massima: built
a bridge. Holds it. // System: expanded. // Question: who exactly came back? //
Next: Book II · PARALLEL

* * *

— END OF BOOK TEN —

— RESURRECTION —

PARALLEL WORLDS · BOOK TWO · PARALLEL · FOLLOWS